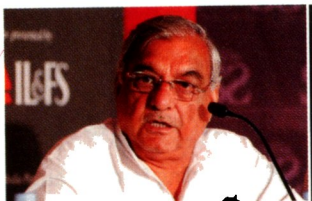


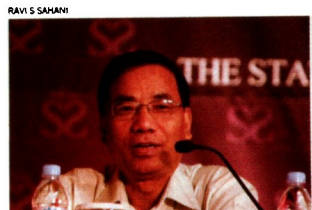
"There should be a cap on what the producer gets and what the consumer pays. Middlemen should not eat all the money."

BHUPINDER SINGH HOODA
CHIEF MINISTER, HARYANA



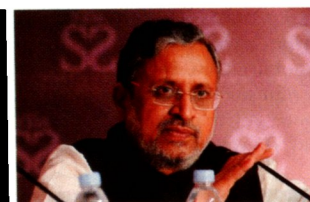
"Mere spending does not mean development. A good delivery system and governance are imperative for any region."

VIRBHADRA SINGH
CHIEF MINISTER, HIMACHAL PRADESH



"We request the finance minister to enable the construction of an agricultural ring road that our Government has proposed."

DR LALZAMA
EDUCATION MINISTER, MIZORAM



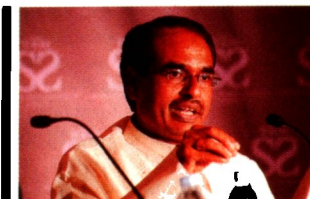
"We all talk about high growth but it is like a train where only the engine is running without bogies and the people."

SUSHIL KUMAR MODI
DEPUTY CHIEF MINISTER, BIHAR



"The more you have, the more you get, the less you have, the less you get. The gap between haves and have-nots has not lessened."

SHEILA DIKSHIT
CHIEF MINISTER, DELHI



"The question is not what or how much the Centre has given. Are we able to give a beneficial price to the farmer? Absolutely not."

SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
CHIEF MINISTER, MADHYA PRADESH



"We have taken healthcare to rural areas. We have a scheme where rural people can get the treatment in the best hospitals."

THANGAM THENNARASU
SCHOOL EDUCATION MINISTER, TAMIL NADU

I do not think this is a blame game. We must give more to farmers. But for that we should be willing to accept structural changes in the manner in which produce moves from the farm to the retail store.

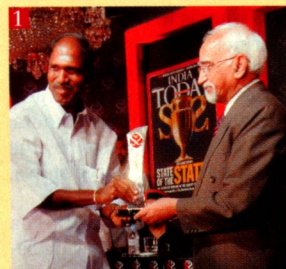
Badal: My suggestion is that the prices of foodgrain should be attached to a price index the same way employees now get enhanced pay packages.

Chawla: We have another big state, Madhya Pradesh. Are you doing anything for agriculture and do you agree with what Mr Badal said or what Mr Chidambaram said?

Shivraj Singh Chouhan, chief minister, Madhya Pradesh: We have reduced the rate of interest on agriculture loans and increased the compensation given to farmers for losses due to natural disasters three times. I would like to make one appeal. This year, our farmers need a fertiliser subsidy of Rs 50,000 crore. We made a provision of Rs 22,000 crore in the budget. At the April 3 meeting with the Centre, we were told we would get whatever we needed. Later, we got a letter that no state can import fertilisers on its own. Ultimately, the loss is that of the farmer.

HALL OF FAME

In all, 30 awards were given to 15 states across 30 categories at the State of the States conclave of 2007



MOMENT OF GLORY: Vice-President Hamid Ansari giving away the awards to 1. Puducherry Chief Minister N. Rangasamy, 2. Punjab Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal, 3. Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan

